
Cohort Design Comparison

A fictional contrast between two non-equivalent planning cohorts.

The names Alpha A-24 and Beta B-16 identify simulated planning groups only. They do not denote participants, patients, clinical cohorts, or actual specimens. Their intended comparison is operational and explicitly non-equivalent.

Design contrast

Dimension	Alpha A-24	Beta B-16	Interpretation limit
Primary role	repeatability planning	workflow contrast	different questions, not pooled
Planning scale	24 synthetic records	16 synthetic records	size is not representativeness
Reference behavior	assay-oriented control path	baseline 1.00 / treated 1.18	values are illustrative
Handling context	single protocol run	alternate handling batch	batch effect remains possible
Comparison claim	within-workflow readiness	scenario sensitivity	not an efficacy comparison

Bias and non-equivalence

Different planned roles, scales, and handling contexts create bias pathways. A difference between the fictional baseline 1.00 and treated 1.18 should be read as a scenario label, not as an effect size. The comparison cannot establish causality or population relevance.

Comparison guardrails

Questions that prevent over-reading the fictional cohorts.

Guardrail question	Why it matters	Review response
Were the cohort roles predeclared?	avoids post-hoc comparison	retain purpose statement
Is the processing context aligned?	handoffs can alter observations	record batch and operator context
Are the values comparable?	baseline and treated labels may encode different workflows	state non-equivalence prominently
Could selection bias explain the contrast?	planning groups are intentionally scoped	do not generalize
What may be concluded?	only operational scenario differences	use for next-method planning

Conclusion

Alpha A-24 and Beta B-16 are useful as separate synthetic planning lenses. They should not be merged, ranked as evidence of a treatment effect, or converted into claims about real research populations. Their difference is a deliberate reminder to preserve context.